

James Mete

Data & AI Director | Analytics, AI/ML, GenAI & Governance | Python, SQL | 12+ Years Experience

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SUMMARY

Canadian Data & AI Director with 12+ years of experience building analytics platforms, ML models, and GenAI automation across high-compliance environments. I've built an enterprise data platform unifying data into executive dashboards, cut document processing time by 83% with an LLM-based automated workflow, engineered ETL pipelines processing over 1.4 billion records, and automated data quality audits supporting platform integrity and GDPR/PDPL compliance. I hold a Master of Applied Data Science from the University of Michigan (4.0 GPA) and have led cross-functional teams across EMEA and APAC.

EXPERIENCE

Digital Transformation Director

Aug 2023 - Present

Sherbiny

Dammam, Saudi Arabia

- Sherbiny is a Saudi industrial solutions manufacturer serving enterprise clients such as Saudi Aramco & SABIC.
- Led a cross-functional team spanning AI, Data, IT, and Software, delivering the ERP/IT, Data & AI roadmap and earning a company-wide top performance award twice.
- Built an enterprise data platform using Python, SQL, GCP, Airflow, and Power BI to unify enterprise-wide data into executive dashboards supporting leadership decisions on liquidity, CapEx, risk and margins.
- Improved sales forecast accuracy by 44% by training/deploying XGBoost machine learning models on ERP data.
- [Reduced RFQ document-processing time by 83%, from 30 minutes to 5 minutes, by building an automated LLM/GenAI workflow](#) with HITL verification that extracts key details from unstructured documents.
- Automated data quality audits on 12k+ records supporting platform integrity, and led data governance by setting IT policies and controls to meet GDPR, PDPL, and Aramco Cybersecurity Compliance standards.
- [Built a full-stack AI bid-analysis Next.js app that ingested 10k+ government tenders](#) with ongoing daily scraping, using PGVector vector-similarity and GenAI to rank tenders against the company profile and surface the bids most likely to win.
- Eliminated manual SLA reporting by building a GenAI pipeline that analyzes survey scores and open-ended comments to auto-generate structured performance reports with improvement recommendations.
- Developed a zero-trust IT/OT architecture plan spanning end-user devices, servers, and network infrastructure for multiple facilities across Saudi and international operations.

Management Analyst (Data & Analytics Manager)

Sep 2019 - Jul 2023

Sherbiny

Dammam, Saudi Arabia

- Led data science, analytics, and data engineering for executive reporting and decision-making.
- Reduced quotation lead time by 92% through SQL performance tuning and Python automation scripts.
- Led launch of [sawab.app](#), an industrial B2B/B2C e-commerce platform, owning business analysis, project management, and stakeholder coordination from inception through successful spinout as a standalone company.
- Delivered end-to-end ERP implementation unifying sales, supply chain, and accounting, building custom modules, dashboards, and authority matrix controls that drove company-wide adoption.
- Managed a cross-functional program to construct a new manufacturing and service center, covering feasibility studies, cost analysis, and facility construction from planning through completion.

- Elected Board of Directors Secretary and member of the Investment & Risk (IRC) and Nomination & Remuneration (NRC) Committees, leading board presentations, investment analysis, and C-level nomination and remuneration guidelines.
- Grew website traffic 121% by rebuilding the company website in React/NodeJS.

Sales & Marketing Analyst (Data Scientist)

Sep 2017 - Aug 2019

Sherbiny

Dammam, Saudi Arabia

- Built ETL pipelines and managed datasets for data collection, cleaning, analysis, forecasting, and dashboards.
- Conducted feasibility studies, sales forecasting, and business analysis to identify growth opportunities and support local manufacturing facility decisions under Saudi Aramco's IKTVA localization program.
- Implemented data-driven sales strategy & targets with the General Manager, driving 45% revenue growth.
- Built an end-to-end Excel billing system from quotation to invoice, streamlining the sales cycle.

Business Analyst

Jul 2014 - Aug 2017

Water and Power Systems Technology

Jubail, Saudi Arabia

- Performed risk-based financial analysis that supported Saudi Investment Bank funding for expansion.

Web Developer

Jan 2012 - Jun 2014

Freelance

Toronto, Canada

- Designed web, graphic, and video assets for streamers Pokimane and Sneaky, reaching 10,000+ daily viewers.

EDUCATION

Master of Applied Data Science

University of Michigan | GPA: 4.0

Ann Arbor, Michigan, USA

Bachelor of Arts

Brock University | Honours

St. Catharines, Ontario, Canada

PROJECTS

Process Optimization Algorithm Simulator

- Demonstration of efficient algorithms to identify bottlenecks in documented processes and offer AI generated feedback to systematically calculate operational workflow performance improvements.

AI Video Quality Prediction

- Built scalable ML pipeline (1.4B+ rows); validated Random Forest model at 82% accuracy / 80% F1 score

Cross-Platform Sentiment Analysis

- Built sentiment analysis pipeline analyzing 3B+ records across Amazon, Reddit, and Twitter

NLP Text Complexity Classifier

- Built NLP text-complexity classifier using engineered features, clustering, and fine-tuned BERT

Open Assistant

- Built scalable ETL pipelines and standardized training datasets for one of the first major open-source LLMs

SKILLS

Python, SQL, ETL, GenAI, LLMs, AI/ML, Data Engineering, Data Science, Data Analytics, Data Governance, Data Quality, GDPR, Power BI, Dashboards, KPIs, AI Strategy, Roadmaps, Change Management, Stakeholder Management, Azure, GCP